

Common Medical Abbreviations Used in Prehospital Care Reports

p-	After	IV	Intravenous
a-	Before	JVD	Jugular venous distention
Δ	Change	KVO	Keep vein open
↓	Decrease	LOC	Loss of consciousness
q-	Every	LS	Lung sounds
↑	Increase	MI	Myocardial infarction
c-	With	MOE	Moves all extremities
s-	Without	MOI	Mechanism of injury
AAA	Abdominal aortic aneurysm	N/G	Nasogastric
ABCs	Airway, breathing, circulation	N/V	Nausea/vomiting
ABD	Abdomen	N/V/D	Nausea/vomiting/diarrhea
ACLS	Advanced cardiac life support	NAD	No apparent distress
ALOC	Altered level of consciousness	NG	Nasogastric
ALS	Advanced life support	NPO	Nothing by mouth
AMA	Against medical advice	OD	Overdose
AMI	Acute myocardial infarction	OPA	Oropharyngeal airway
APAP	Acetaminophen	P	Pulse
ASA	Aspirin	PC	After eating
AVPU	Alert, verbal, painful, unresponsive	PERL	Pupils equal and reactive
BID	Twice a day	PID	Pelvic inflammatory disease
BP	Blood pressure	PMH	Previous medical history
BS	Blood sugar	PO	By mouth
c/c	Chief complaint	PRN	Whenever necessary
C/O or c/o	Complains of	Pt	Patient
CA	Cancer	PTA	Prior to arrival
CAD	Coronary artery disease	QID	4 times/day
CHF	Congestive heart failure	QXh	Every X hours
Clr	Clear	R/O	Rule out
CNS	Central nervous system	resp	Respirations
CP	Chest pain	Rx	Treatment/prescription
CSF	Cerebral spinal fluid	s/s	Signs/symptoms
CSM	Circulation/sensory/motor	SL	Sublingual
CVA	Cerebral vascular accident	SNT	Soft, nontender
Cx	Chief complaint	SOB	Short of breath
cx	Chest	SPO ₂	Pulse oximeter oxygen saturation
D/C	Discontinue	Sx	Symptoms
Dx	Diagnosis	Sz	Seizure
EMS	Emergency medical services	TIA	Transient ischemic attack
ETOH	Alcohol	TID	3 times/day
FROM	Full range of motion	TKO	To keep open
fx	Fracture	U/A	Upon arrival
HA	Headache	UTI	Urinary tract infection
HTN	Hypertension	V-Fib	Ventricular fibrillation
Hx	History	V-Tac	Ventricular tachycardia
IM	Intramuscular	WNL	Within normal limits
IO	Intraosseous		